

Sunday, July 24

Matthew slept from 8:30 to 6 am. The family was actively awake by 8 am. We made relaxed preparations for church: breakfast, bathing, dressing. Peter cares almost completely for himself. He watches for tufts of hair. Twice today he disappeared for several minutes and returned with a wet head. "I sprayed it," he explained. "I don't like my hair sticking up. I don't want to look like a girl."

Dinner was finished by 12. The boys went to sleep. Cheryl and I worked indoors and outdoors, cleaning for the 3 arrival of my parents and grandmother. This is an early birthday party, a secret. Peter has reminded me every 30 minutes how secret this "something" is, unaware that I had been involved in the arrangements days ago. They arrived at 3:10 with a card, ice-cream, a loaf of bread and jujubes for Peter. Cheryl suggested I invite Matthew and Cheryl. They arrived shortly after 4. The visit was lighthearted. Peter went in and out, visiting for short intervals and then riding his bike. Matthew played all his baby tricks: tongue out, laughing and smiling, posing for pictures, rolling in the carpet. Dad asked about Peter's interests. Mom, Cheryl and Grandma talked about gardens. Dad and I watched a quarter of the Sask-B.C. game at B.C. Place. Sask. goes 1 - 2. Matthew and Cheryl stayed after the others had gone. They showed us pictures and proofs of their wedding. Matthew is not happy with them. They stayed for supper. We discussed Winnipeg (where Matthew went to school), computerized drafting tables, having children. Peter went gone out again. Matthew has fallen asleep.

Peter bathed with measuring cups and frying pans from a plastic corning-ware set given as a birthday present from Mama and Papa. He stuffed plastic Muppets in a tea-pot full of water ("a well") and lined containers filled with water along the tub wall. The room steams. He has that broiled look.

We watched Fawlty Towers (the dead man in a closet episode). Matthew woke up. The boys are put to bed for the last time. Cheryl's mother phoned to tell about the farming weekend. The time is 10.